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MR. FIVE-FOR-FIVE

Cooper Put on a Hot Show in Previous Denver Visit

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DENVER—Arriving here today with the Indianapolis Indians, Manager Walker Cooper paused to recount that it was here that he had one of his greatest days in baseball.

But Cooper may not get the opportunity for a repeat performance in the three-game series which opens tonight. He's still limping a little from the pulled leg muscle suffered in Indianapolis last Friday.

In his first and only appearance in Bears Stadium, Cooper blasted three consecutive home runs, a double and a single in five trips. That was in 1952 when Cooper was a member of the Boston Braves.



Koelling

"We stopped off here for an exhibition game that spring," recalled Cooper, "and we beat Andy Cohen's club something like 17-0. That double almost was a homer, too, but it hit high on the fence and bounced back."

The Indians, arriving by train from Indianapolis, were greeted by a caravan of cars this morning and immediately whisked into formation of a long downtown parade. They will meet the Bears tonight in Denver's home opener before an estimated crowd of 10,000.

Manager Cooper has nominated big Jim Derrington for the pitching assignment in the hopes that his reputed fast ball will do some jumping in the light air here. The bonus southpaw lasted only 3½ innings against the Bears in his first start at Indianapolis last week, but that was only four days after he had hurled nine innings in an exhibition game,

his longest stretch in two years.

This will be the second time that Indianapolis has provided the opposition for a Denver home opener. In 1955, the first year for Denver in the A.A., the Indians were tromped, 10-1, before 13,840. In three seasons of play at Denver, the Indians have won only 11 of 33 games.

Probable changes in the Tribe lineup tonight will include John Romano catching and Bobby Winkles back at short in place of Phil Mateja, who has shown a weakness on defense. Romano has had only a limited amount of spring training work and has been handicapped by a pulled leg muscle, but Manager Cooper wants to get the big fellow in action as soon as possible. Romano is always a long-ball threat and that's what the Indians are lacking.

Joe Altobelli, who suffered a chipped bone on the index finger of his left hand last week, is expected to return to action sometime on this trip. Meanwhile, Jim McAnany is getting an opportunity to prove himself and the youngster from Los Angeles is making the most of the chance. He has contributed five hits and three RBI's in the last three victories.



SAFETY SPECIAL

